

Your AI Is Only As Good As Your Data: Building An AI-Ready Foundation For The Supply Chain

Vas Plessas



**This Session Features
a Live Interactive Poll**

From Conference Navigator App

- Register and open this session in your “Agenda”
- Scroll to poll(s) and participate

Powered by

Gartner®
Peer **Community™**

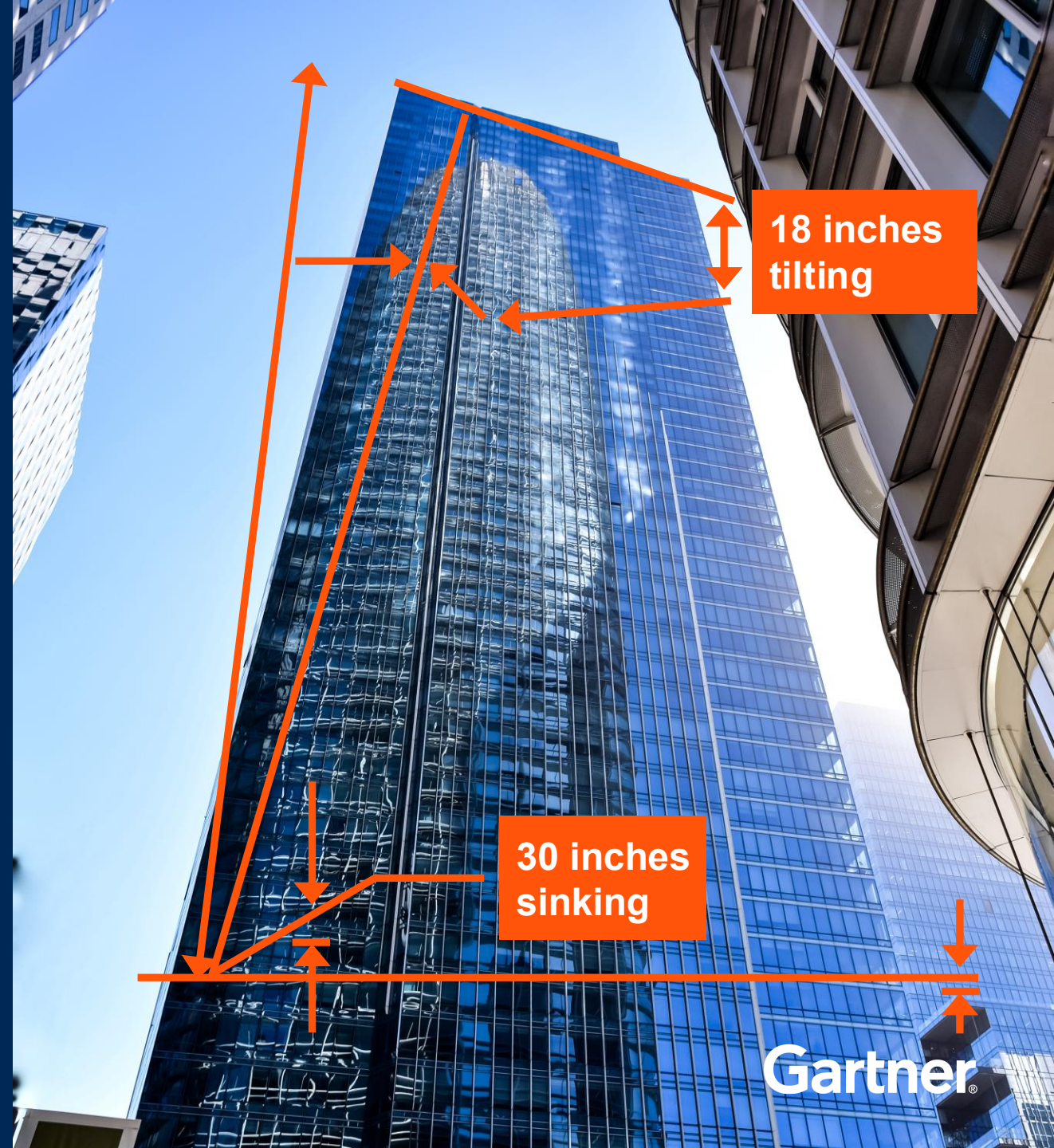
© 2026 Gartner, Inc. and/or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Gartner is a registered trademark of Gartner, Inc. and its affiliates. This publication may not be reproduced or distributed in any form without Gartner's prior written permission. It consists of the opinions of Gartner's Business and Technology Insights organization, which should not be construed as statements of fact. While the information contained in this publication has been obtained from sources believed to be reliable, Gartner disclaims all warranties as to the accuracy, completeness or adequacy of such information. Although Gartner business and technology insights may address legal and financial issues, Gartner does not provide legal or investment advice and its insights should not be construed or used as such. Your access and use of this publication are governed by [Gartner's Usage Policy](#). Gartner prides itself on its reputation for independence and objectivity. Its insights are produced independently by its Business and Technology Insights organization without input or influence from any third party. For further information, see "[Guiding Principles on Independence and Objectivity](#)."

Gartner®

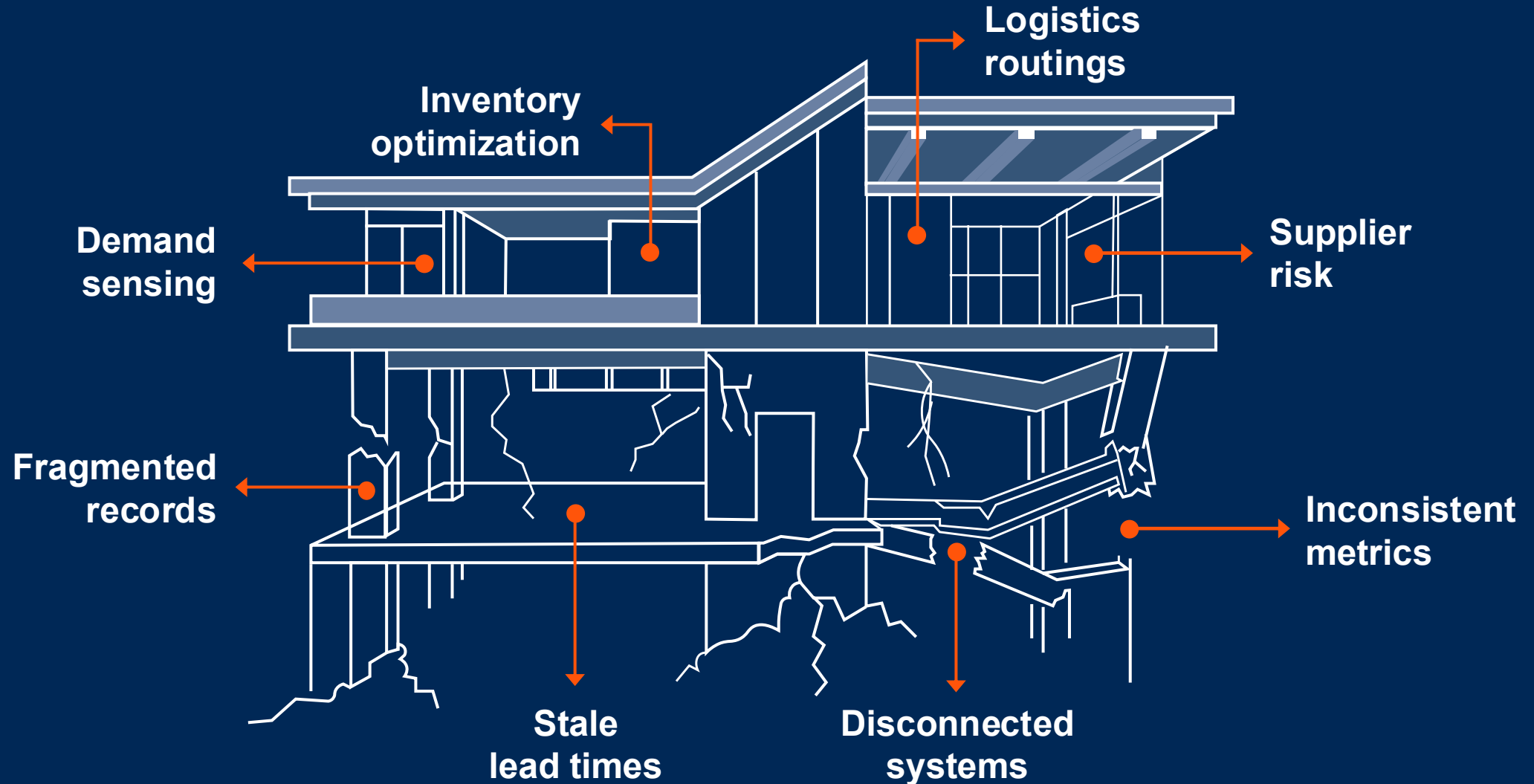
The Millennium Tower

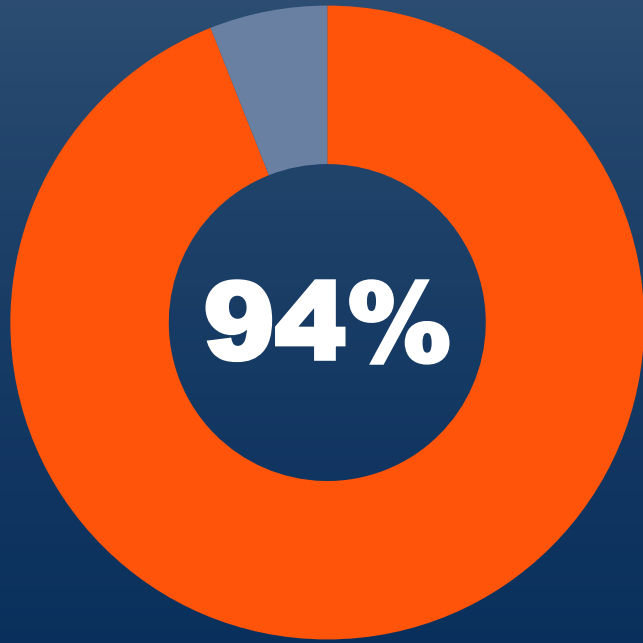
58 stories. \$10M units. Sinking.

Saved \$10M on foundation.
Repair estimate: \$100M-\$500M.



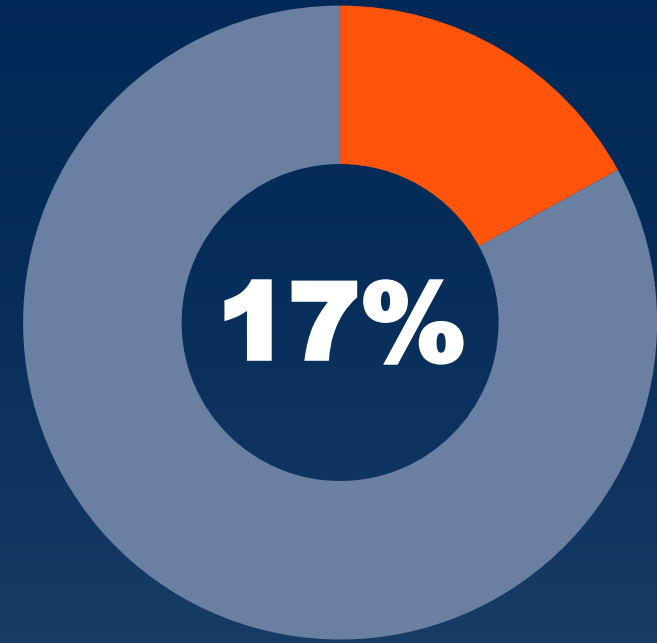
Building on Shaky Foundations





**want to integrate
AI into supply chain
operations.**

**But
only**



**have successfully
deployed AI applications
at scale.**

You Are Optimizing Data for the Wrong Consumer

Optimized for humans



Optimized for AI



Thinking about AI within your supply chain organization, which of the following best describes your current maturity level?

From Conference Navigator App

- Register and open this session in your “Agenda”
- Scroll to poll(s) and participate

Thinking about AI within your supply chain organization, which of the following best describes your current maturity level?

KEEP THIS BOX
single-select

Scaling successfully — AI is delivering measurable value across multiple use cases.

Piloting — we have promising experiments but struggle to scale them.

Stuck — we've invested but aren't seeing the returns we expected.

Early stage — we're still building the foundation.

Not investing — we're not actively evaluating AI for our supply chain.

From Conference Navigator App

- Register and open this session in your “Agenda”
- Scroll to poll(s) and participate

The 3Cs of AI-Ready Data

1



Connected —
linking your supply
chain data so AI sees
the full network

2



Contextual —
giving your data a
shared definition and
consistent meaning

3

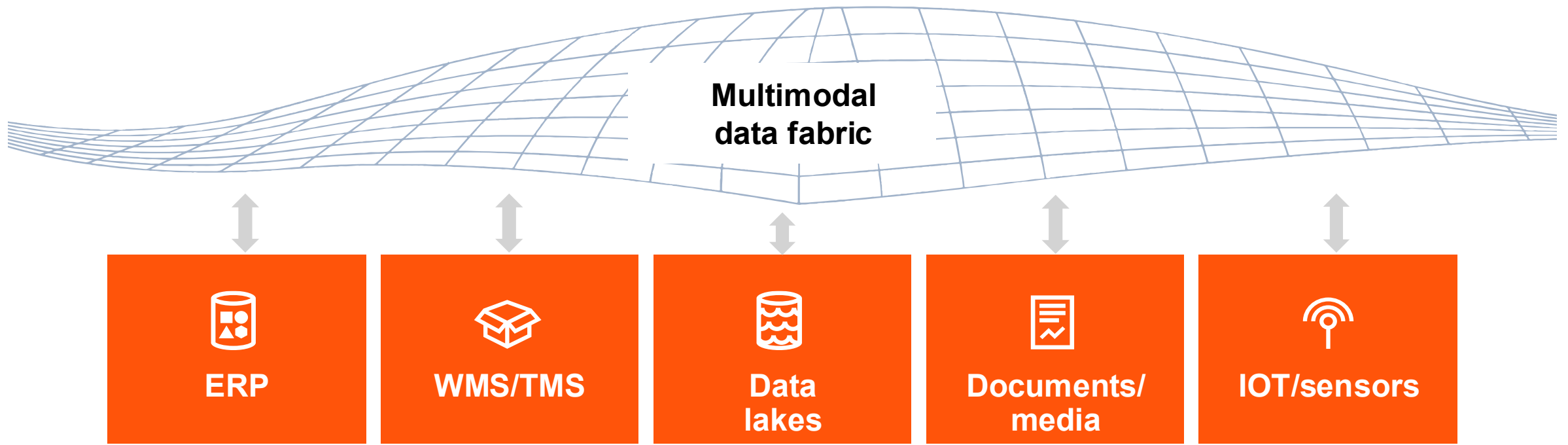


Continuous —
keeping your data
current and improving
with use

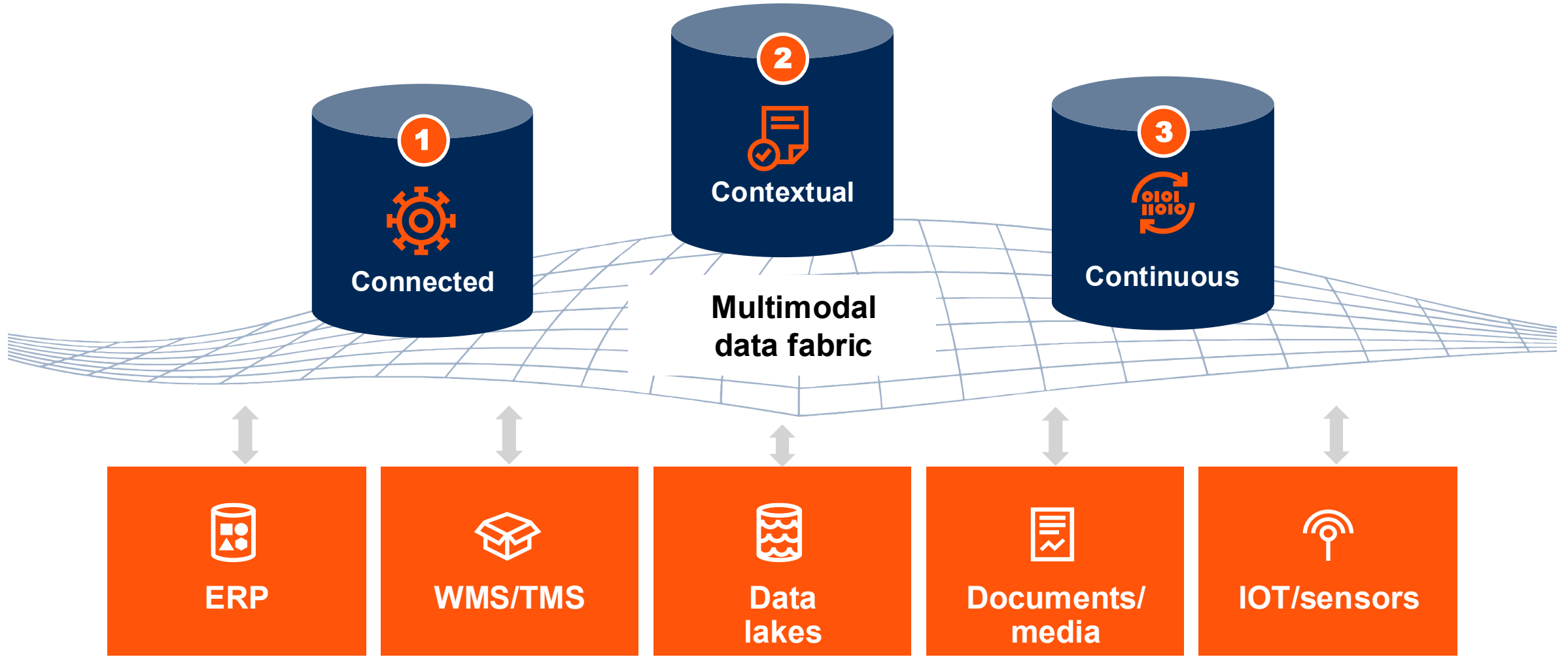
Build on What You Already Have, Connect What You Don't



Build on What You Already Have, Connect What You Don't



Build on What You Already Have, Connect What You Don't



Key Topics

1



Connected —
linking your supply
chain data so AI sees
the full network

2



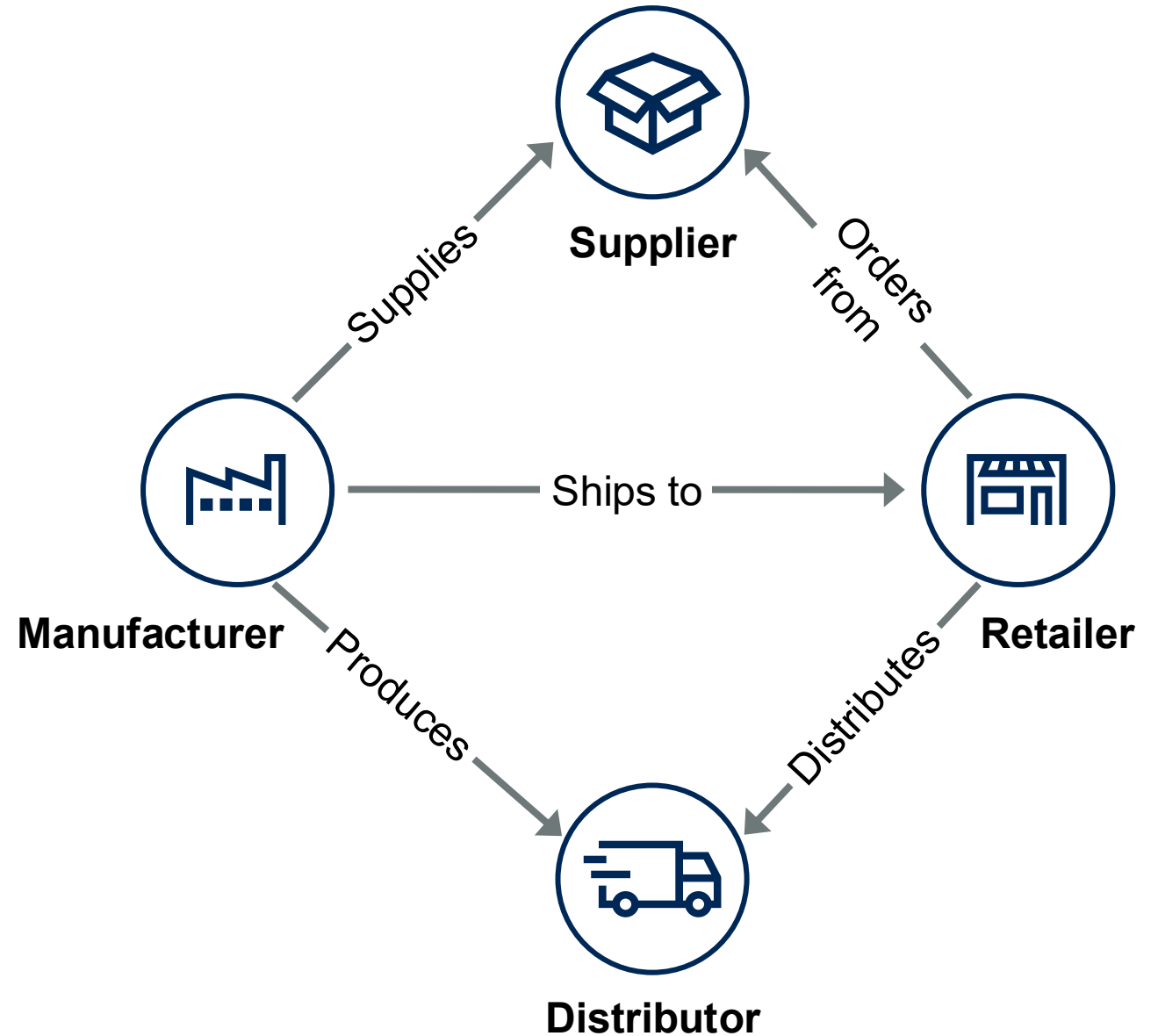
Contextual —
giving your data a
shared definition and
consistent meaning

3



Continuous —
keeping your data
current and improving
with use

Your AI Sees the Full Chain of Dependencies



Supply Chain Intelligence Platform

Lenovo

800+

data sources
connected

20%

cost
reduction

5%

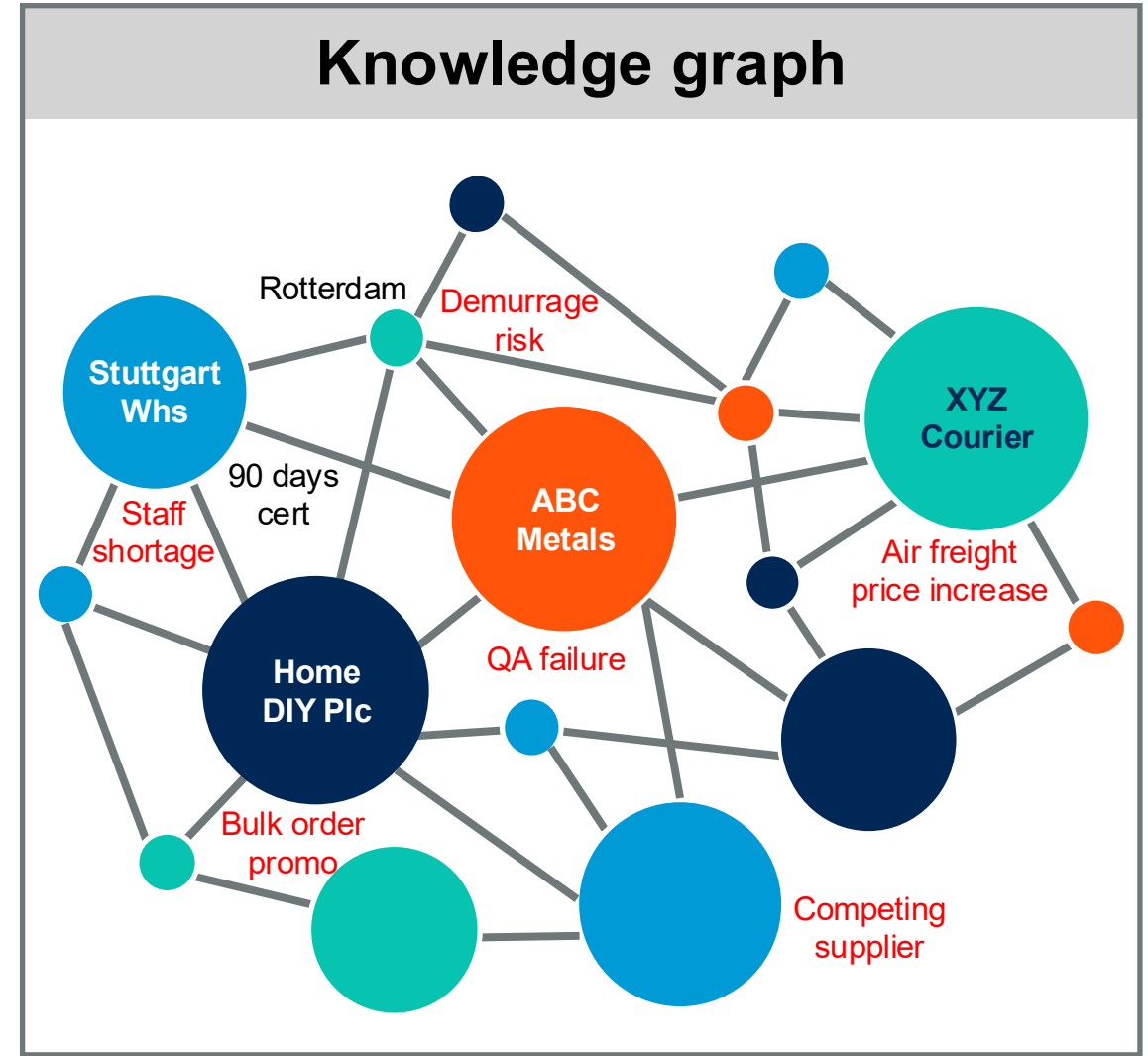
OTIF
improvement

70%

daily
users

Traced tier-1 and
tier-2 disruption
impact in minutes

What Your Experts Know, Your AI Should Know Too





Define the **blueprint. Own
the **business** case. Enable
knowledge capture.**

Key Topics

1



Connected —

linking your supply chain data so AI sees the full network

2



Contextual —

giving your data a shared definition and consistent meaning

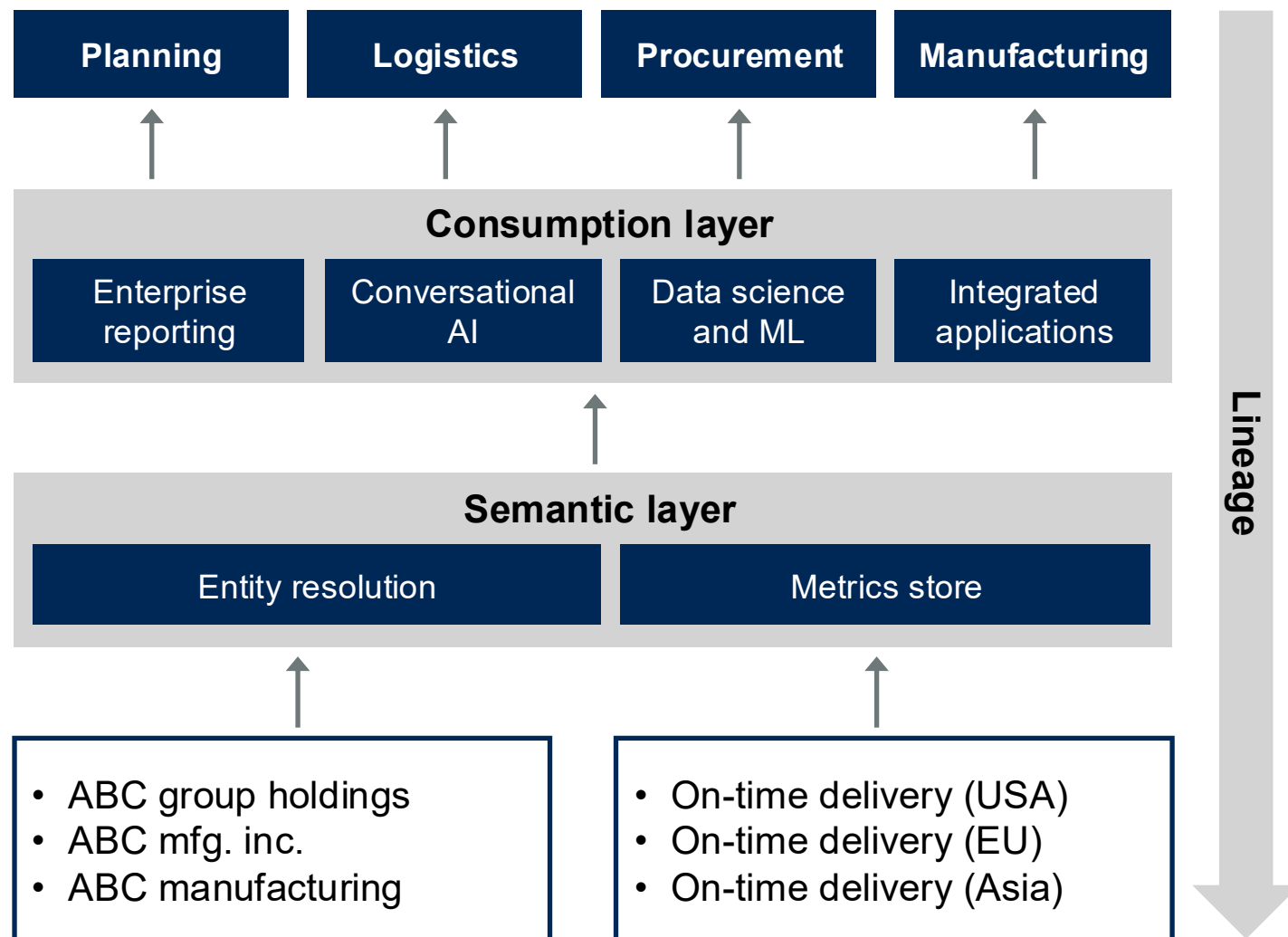
3



Continuous —

keeping your data current and improving with use

One Authoritative Meaning Everywhere



Semantics First Architecture



120x

faster answers
to critical business
questions.

Unified

supply and
demand identity.

Enriched

underlying
data semantics.

Scaled

exponential
decision-making
speed.

Trust Is Earned, Not Configured



Human **in** the loop



System logs
acceptance patterns



Operators review and approve
every recommendation



Human **on** the loop



AI initiates and runs the
process



Operators monitor and
manage by exception



Human **off** the loop



Autonomous decision
making



Operators set the
guardrails

From



To



Set the **standards. Govern
the shared **meaning** to protect
your operational **reality.****

Key Topics

1



Connected —

linking your supply chain data so AI sees the full network

2



Contextual —

giving your data a shared definition and consistent meaning

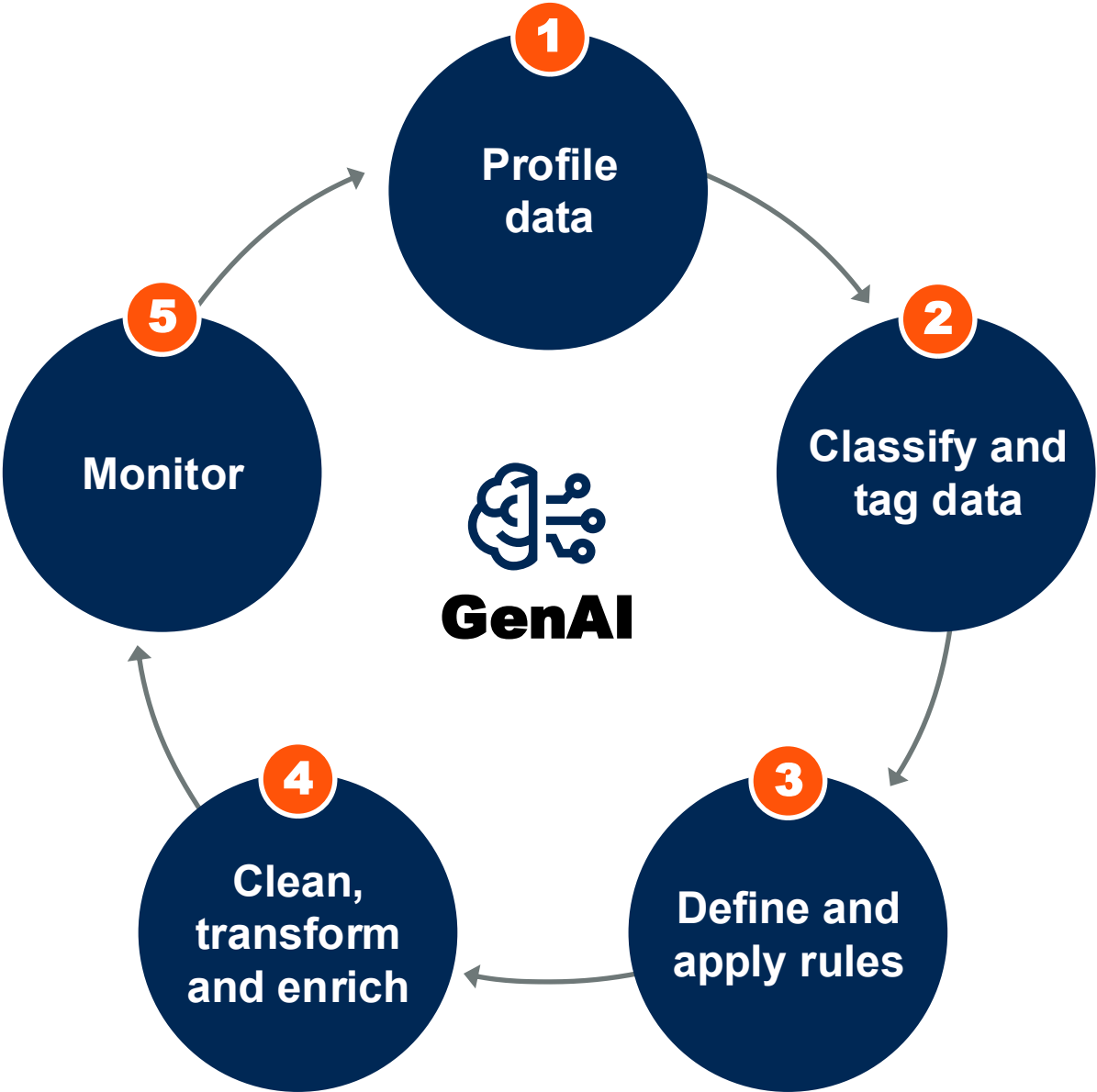
3



Continuous —

keeping your data current and improving with use

Data Quality as an Ongoing Discipline



Global Supply Chain Data Factory



80%

expired
records resolved.

20%

elimination in safety
stock overestimation.

180

countries with
automated authorship.

real-time

machine learning
model feeding.

Extending Data Quality to the Business

Traditional view: Data quality as IT's responsibility



AI-driven shared accountability





This isn't about moving data quality out of IT. It's about extending it into the business.

Path A

Invest in the penthouse ignore
the foundation. Sink.



Path B

Build AI-ready data. Build the human
systems. Compound.



Action Plan

- 1 ***Pick*** your most critical AI use case.
- 2 ***Partner*** with IT to start designing the architecture.
- 3 ***Prioritize*** the human element from day one.



The algorithms are available to everyone. The data foundation is your competitive advantage.

Recommended Gartner Insights

To learn more about access to Gartner, expert insight, and peer communities, contact your Gartner representative or click on “Become A Client” on gartner.com to speak with one of our specialists.

- 🔍 [AI's Unique Needs Drive Shifts in Supply Chain Data Management Strategy](#)
Vas Plessas
- 🔍 [Emerging Tech for CSCOs: Scale AI and Accelerate Decision Making With Data Fabric](#)
Vas Plessas
- 🔍 [AI Revolutionizes Supply Chain Data Management, Accelerating Digital Transformation](#)
Vas Plessas
- 🔍 [Supply Chain Executive Report: Closing the AI Expectations-Reality Gap](#)
Benjamin Jury and Vas Plessas